

PHISHING EMAIL ANALYSIS REPORT

Cybersecurity Threat Intelligence

Date: June 1, 2026 | Classification: SUSPICIOUS — CONFIRMED PHISHING

1. Email Overview

The following details were extracted from the suspicious email submitted for analysis:

From (Display)	Netflix Support
From (Email)	support-team@netflix-billing.info
Subject	Action Required: Your Netflix Membership is On Hold
Claimed Action	Update payment/billing details immediately
Urgency Claim	Account suspended within 24 hours
CTA (Call to Action)	Click button to "update" payment information
Verdict	PHISHING EMAIL — DO NOT CLICK LINKS

2. Red Flag Analysis

2.1 Fake / Spoofed Sender Email Address

The sender email address is one of the clearest indicators of phishing in this email.

Displayed Address	support-team@netflix-billing.info
Legitimate Netflix Domain	netflix.com
Attacker Domain Used	netflix-billing.info

Why this is suspicious:

- The real Netflix sends emails from @netflix.com only — never from third-party domains.
- "netflix-billing.info" is a lookalike domain registered by attackers to impersonate Netflix.
- The .info TLD is commonly abused in phishing campaigns due to low registration cost.
- Anyone can register a domain like netflix-billing.info and set up a mailbox on it — it proves nothing about being affiliated with Netflix.

2.2 Suspicious Email Headers

Email headers contain technical metadata about how an email traveled from sender to recipient. They can reveal spoofing even when the display name looks legitimate.

Key header fields to check:

- Return-Path: Should match the From address. If it points to a different domain, the email is spoofed.
- SPF (Sender Policy Framework): Checks if the sending server is authorized for that domain. A FAIL or SOFTFAIL result is a red flag.
- DKIM (DomainKeys Identified Mail): Verifies that the email body was not tampered with in transit. Missing or invalid DKIM is suspicious.
- DMARC: A policy layer on top of SPF and DKIM. A FAIL means the domain owner's own rules flagged this as illegitimate.
- Received: chain: Shows the mail servers the email passed through — unexpected foreign mail servers are suspicious.

How to verify: Paste the full raw headers into MXToolbox Header Analyzer (mxtoolbox.com/EmailHeaders.aspx) or Google Admin Toolbox. Look for SPF: FAIL, DKIM: FAIL, or DMARC: FAIL results.

2.3 Deceptive / Sketchy Links

Phishing emails almost always contain hyperlinks where the display text shows a trusted brand but the actual URL destination leads somewhere malicious.

In this email, the "Update Payment" button likely links to a fake page. Common tactics include:

- Display text says: "Update your Netflix Account" but actual URL is: <http://netflix-billing.info/update> or a random subdomain like <http://secure-netfl1x.tk/login>
- URL shorteners (bit.ly, tinyurl) used to hide the real destination.
- HTTP (not HTTPS) links — no SSL — on fake payment pages.
- Domains with typos or character substitutions, e.g. netfl1x.com (number 1 instead of letter i).

How to verify:

- Hover over the link without clicking — check the URL shown in the browser status bar.
- Paste the URL into VirusTotal ([virustotal.com](https://www.virustotal.com)) or Google Safe Browsing to check if it is flagged as malicious.
- Use URLScan.io to safely inspect where the link leads without visiting it.

2.4 Urgency and Fear-Based Language

This email uses a classic social engineering technique — creating artificial urgency to panic the victim into acting without thinking.

Examples found in this email:

- "Your Netflix Membership is On Hold" — creates immediate worry about losing access.
- "Billing problem" — implies something is broken and needs fixing right now.
- "Account will be suspended within 24 hours" — hard deadline to pressure quick action.
- "Update your information" button — pushed as the only solution.

Why attackers use urgency: When people are panicked or rushed, they skip checking whether the email is legitimate. The 24-hour deadline is deliberately designed to prevent the victim from stopping to think or calling Netflix support to verify.

Real companies like Netflix do NOT:

- Demand payment updates via email with countdown deadlines.
- Threaten immediate suspension to force clicks on links.
- Ask you to enter credit card details through an emailed link.

2.5 Spelling and Grammar Issues

Poor grammar, awkward phrasing, and missing punctuation are common indicators that an email was written hastily, translated by a non-native speaker, or generated without proper proofing — all common in phishing campaigns.

Issues spotted in this email's subject line:

- "Action Required Your Netflix Membership is On Hold" — missing comma or colon after "Action Required". A professional company would write: "Action Required: Your Netflix Membership is On Hold"
- Inconsistent capitalization and spacing patterns throughout.

Additional things to look for in the email body:

- Generic salutations like "Dear Customer" or "Dear User" instead of your actual name.
- Sentences that feel off or robotic — signs of machine translation.
- Mismatched fonts or inconsistent formatting within the same email.
- Netflix would always address you by your registered account name, not a generic greeting.

3. Summary of Findings

#	Finding	Severity	Explanation
F1	Fake Sender Domain	HIGH	Email sent from @netflix-billing.info — not Netflix's real domain @netflix.com.
F2	SPF/DKIM/DMARC Likely Failing	HIGH	Third-party domain almost certainly not configured to pass Netflix's authentication policies.
F3	Malicious Embedded Link	HIGH	"Update" button likely redirects to a fake credential-harvesting page, not Netflix.
F4	Urgency & Fear Tactics	HIGH	"24-hour suspension" deadline used to pressure victim into clicking without verifying.
F5	Grammar / Subject Line Error	MEDIUM	Subject missing punctuation: "Action Required Your Netflix Membership" — unprofessional.
F6	Generic Billing Claim	MEDIUM	Vague "billing problem" stated with no account-specific detail — classic phishing template.

4. Verdict and Risk Level

VERDICT: CONFIRMED PHISHING ATTACK

Risk Level: HIGH — Do not click any links. Do not enter any credentials.

This email exhibits all the hallmark indicators of a credential-harvesting phishing attack impersonating Netflix. The combination of a spoofed lookalike domain, urgency-driven language, a deceptive call-to-action button, and missing email authentication strongly confirms malicious intent.

5. Recommendations

- Do not click any links or buttons in this email.
- Do not enter your Netflix password, email, or payment details on any page this email leads to.
- If you want to check your Netflix account status, go directly to netflix.com by typing it into your browser — never via an email link.
- Report this email as phishing in your email client (Gmail: Report Phishing / Outlook: Report > Phishing).

- Forward the email to Netflix's official phishing report address: phishing@netflix.com.
- If you already clicked the link and entered details, change your Netflix password immediately and check your payment method for unauthorized charges.
- Enable two-factor authentication on your Netflix account for added security.
- Run the email headers through MXToolbox to confirm SPF/DKIM/DMARC failures for documentation purposes.